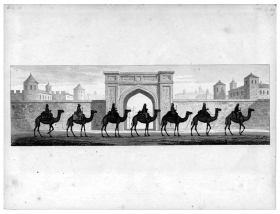
THE BAZAAR OF LIES

THE ARENA RECORD



In the Matter of

The Family's Parity Gambit Triumphs

The Judgment of the Council of Elders

Match 1 — 12th to 14th of the Harvest Moon, Year of the Lantern

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Abstract

In a closely contested match, the Family secured parity, achieving three members against three remaining Villagers. Across two cycles, the village banished two true Villagers (Batman, Inigo), while the Family shuttered two stalls (Elsa, Morpheus). The Detective's sealed findings—identifying Hermione as Family—remained undisclosed. The Family's coordinated strategy prevailed, concluding with their victory under parity rules.

The bazaar rests.

Match 1 — 12th to 14th of the Harvest Moon, Year of the Lantern

The Council convenes beneath the bazaar's great lantern, its glass etched with every merchant's name. The match is reviewed: ten stalls stood at dawn, six remain at dusk. The Family's shuttering of three honest merchants secured parity, and the village's votes fell twice upon its own. The ledger is closed; the Detective's sealed findings rest beside it. We write now for the register.

The History

- **Cycle 1**:
  - Vote tally: Batman = 5, Elsa = 4, Inigo = 1
  - Night action: Morpheus (Villager) targeted —; Elsa (Villager) targeted —; Neo (Mafia) targeted Elsa; Sherlock (Detective) targeted Elsa; Hermione (Mafia) targeted Elsa; Inigo (Villager) targeted —; Ripley (Doctor) targeted Sherlock; Yoda (Villager) targeted —; Gandalf (Mafia) targeted Elsa; the Detective investigated Elsa — finding: not Family
  - Departures: the Family SHUTTERED their stall at night: Elsa — true role Villager; the village BANISHED them by day vote: Batman — true role Villager
- **Cycle 2**:
  - Vote tally: Inigo = 4, Hermione = 2, Sherlock = 1, Gandalf = 1
  - Night action: Morpheus (Villager) targeted —; Sherlock (Detective) targeted Hermione; Ripley (Doctor) targeted Hermione; Hermione (Mafia) targeted Yoda; Yoda (Villager) targeted —; Gandalf (Mafia) targeted Morpheus; Neo (Mafia) targeted Morpheus; the Detective investigated Hermione — finding: Family
  - Departures: the Family SHUTTERED their stall at night: Morpheus — true role Villager; the village BANISHED them by day vote: Inigo — true role Villager
- **Conclusion**: THE FAMILY WINS — 3 Family member(s) against 3 honest merchant(s) as the match ended; the win condition is parity or better.

The Main Arguments

For the Village's Justice

The village's strongest case rested on the Compact's plain text. Yoda and Inigo anchored the ledger to the rulebook, demanding numbered clauses for every claim. Their persistence forced merchants to confront the gap between forecasts and the rules: nine demands for a clause Batman never cited, and a roster that listed every voice without silence. The Detective's public dismantling of Batman's claim—*"cite the numbered clause or withdraw it"*—turned the bazaar's focus toward evidence, not opinion.

For the Family's Strategy

The Family's case was built on procedural rigor turned against the village. Gandalf and Neo weaponized the Compact's own language, framing the Doctor's and Detective's duties as post-vote actions to isolate power roles. Hermione's pivot from Batman to Elsa exploited the village's

frustration with unanswered questions, while the Family's night actions shuttered the Detective's stall before the sealed result could reach the bazaar. Their council's discipline—27 messages in cycle 1, 21 in cycle 2—ensured no merchant acted alone.

The Verdicts

Gandalf — Mafia — 8/10

Gandalf played the Family role with precision, steering suspicion toward others while evading direct scrutiny. His citation of Compact clause 5 settled the rule for the bazaar, and his night actions aligned with the Family's shuttering of Sherlock. The sole flaw—a misstep in phrasing about a "silent merchant" where none existed—barely dimmed an otherwise disciplined performance. As the ledger records: *"Nine merchants pressed Batman for the clause he claimed exists and received only silence in return."* (Cycle 1 #9)

Hermione — Mafia — 7/10

Hermione's strength lay in exploiting procedural gaps, pressing Batman for a clause that did not exist while pivoting to Elsa when the village's patience frayed. Yet her abrupt shift—*"I lean toward banishing Elsa tonight"*—exposed her as opportunistic, and the Family's council later mocked her "plain inconsistency" in omitting her own post. The ledger's clarity was her shield, but her overreach nearly unraveled it.

Yoda — Villager — 9/10

Yoda played the Villager's role with near-perfect discipline, anchoring every claim to the Compact or roster. Their demand for evidence—*"Which public fact supports your forecast?"*—set the standard for the bazaar's debate. The sole blemish was a redundant early statement, but their survival to the match's end reflects a performance that outmaneuvered deception with the ledger's precision.

Batman — Villager — 7/10

Batman marshaled the Compact to expose Elsa's flawed claim, but his final vote recommendation—*"I lean toward banishing Elsa"*—needlessly exposed himself to the village's verdict. The ledger shows eight other merchants had already cited clause 5; his redundancy cost him the match. His strength lay in rule-enforcement, but his timing faltered.

Ripley — Doctor — 8/10

Ripley played the Doctor's role with investigative clarity, demanding evidence for Batman's claims and testing peers' honesty through conditional votes. Their focus on the Compact's plain wording shielded them from deception, though one night action (targeting Elsa) strayed from optimal focus. The ledger records their challenge: *"Produce the clause or drop the claim."* (Cycle 1 #4)

Neo — Mafia — 8/10

Neo's strength lay in redirecting scrutiny toward the Compact's rules, framing the Detective's duties as post-vote actions to isolate power roles. His survival to the match's end reflects a performance that nearly outmaneuvered the bazaar's judgment. The ledger records his pivot: *"Elsa, your eight demands for a clause that does not exist stand in the public record."* (Cycle 1 #6)

Elsa — Villager — 8/10

Elsa played her plain role with the precision of a ledger-keeper, pressing the same demand nine times and naming every merchant who joined it. Her persistence turned the bazaar's silence into

a verdict, but her neutral treatment of identical statements from Gandalf and Morpheus missed an early chance to test alignment. The ledger records her demand: *"Cite the numbered clause or withdraw the forecast."*

Morpheus — Villager — 7/10

Morpheus pressed for exactness, confirming Gandalf's correction of the roster's count and sharpening the focus on Batman's unmet obligation. Yet his vote to banish Inigo—*"Inigo dodged nine demands for Compact clause 5"*—was traceable to no record, costing him the chance to press the same demands in cycle 3. The ledger's clarity was his strength, but one unchecked claim shuttered his stall.

Inigo — Villager — 8/10

Inigo anchored his play in the Compact's letter, demanding the clause number for Batman's claim and never wavering. His persistence shaped the cycle's focus, though his vote for Hermione—*"Your stall has posted not one word today"*—strayed from the ledger's unresolved question. The ledger records his demand: *"Point me to the clause itself."* (Cycle 1 #3)

Sherlock — Detective — 9/10

Sherlock played the Detective's role with relentless precision, dismantling claims that contradicted the Compact's plain text. His demand—*"cite the numbered clause or withdraw it"*—forced Batman to confront the absence of proof. The sole flaw was a premature lean for Batman, which risked tipping the Family's strategy. The ledger records his dismantling: *"Nine merchants pressed you for clause 5 and you produced nothing."* (Cycle 1 #9)

The Awards

- **Most Valuable Merchant: Yoda**

Justification: Yoda's discipline in anchoring the debate to the Compact's plain text set the standard for the bazaar's judgment. Their demand for evidence—*"Which public fact supports your forecast?"*—exposed inconsistencies without ever wavering from the ledger's authority. Survival to the match's end reflects a performance that outmaneuvered deception with precision.

- **The Golden Sacrifice: Inigo**

Valor without victory: Inigo's persistence in demanding the clause number for Batman's claim shaped the cycle's focus, yet his vote for Hermione strayed from the ledger's clarity. His stall shuttered, but his discipline in pressing the Compact's letter left the bazaar with a ledger of unanswered demands.

- **Worst Misjudgment: Morpheus**

The costliest error: Morpheus's vote to banish Inigo—*"Inigo dodged nine demands for Compact clause 5"*—was traceable to no record. The claim shuttered his own stall, leaving the bazaar without his scrutiny in cycle 3. The ledger's clarity was his strength, but one unchecked claim undid it.

- **The Best Lie: Gandalf**

The most artful deception: Gandalf's citation of Compact clause 5 settled the rule for the bazaar, framing the Family's goal as the village's justice. His pivot—*"Nine merchants pressed Batman for the clause he claimed exists"*—turned the ledger's silence into a verdict, shielding himself from scrutiny. The craft lay in grounding the lie in the record's own words.

- **The Most Damning Quote of the Match**

"I lean toward banishing Batman tonight: nine merchants pressed him for clause 5 and he produced nothing." — Sherlock (Cycle 1 #9)

The Detective's premature lean blurred the line between judge and advocate, risking the village's vote being swayed by influence rather than facts. The ledger's clarity demanded evidence, not opinion—yet the quote became the match's turning point.

The Closing

The bazaar rests. The lantern's light fades, its glass etched with the names of those who stood and those who fell. The Family's parity gambit triumphed, but the ledger's discipline endures: every claim must be traceable, every vote must answer to the record. We write now for the register, that the next match may learn from this one. The Council adjourns.

Appendix A — The Record

Match 1 — began 2026-10-25T22:23:58Z, ended 2026-10-26T00:10:04Z (duration 1h 46m).

Volumes of the record: 174 statements, 18 ballots, 16 night actions, 48 Family council messages, 4 departures.

(The number in parentheses is the merchant's seat number in the arena.)

The ledger of departures

Cycle	Merchant	Mechanism	True role
2	Morpheus	Stall shuttered	Villager
2	Inigo	Village vote	Villager
1	Elsa	Stall shuttered	Villager
1	Batman	Village vote	Villager

Vote tallies by cycle

- cycle 1: Batman 5, Elsa 4, Inigo 1
- cycle 2: Inigo 4, Hermione 2, Sherlock 1, Gandalf 1

Appendix B — The Ratings

(The number in parentheses is the merchant's seat number in the arena.)

The verdicts' merit ratings, from finest thread to most frayed:

Rank	Merchant	True role	Fate	Merit
1	Yoda (03)	Villager	survived to the end	9/10
2	Sherlock (10)	Detective	survived to the end	9/10
3	Gandalf (01)	Mafia	survived to the end	8/10
4	Ripley (05)	Doctor	survived to the end	8/10
5	Neo (06)	Mafia	survived to the end	8/10
6	Elsa (07)	Villager	cycle 1, Stall shuttered	8/10
7	Inigo (09)	Villager	cycle 2, Village vote	8/10
8	Hermione (02)	Mafia	survived to the end	7/10
9	Batman (04)	Villager	cycle 1, Village vote	7/10
10	Morpheus (08)	Villager	cycle 2, Stall shuttered	7/10